Le Futur Proche et Le Passé Récent

Le Futur Proche (The Near Future)

The Futur Proche expresses what is going to happen in the near or immediate future. Furthermore, it indicates that the speaker is relatively certain that the future event will actually happen. It is the equivalent of **going to + infinitive** in English.

To conjugate it, we use **aller** (**in present tense**) **+ Infinitive** (of the main action verb). The verb **aller** is conjugated in present tense in accordance with the subject who is going to perform the action in the near future.

Aller (in present tense) + Infinitive of the main action verb

Français	English
Nous **allons étudier** régulièrement.	We are **going to study** regularly.
Je **vais présenter** mon ami.	I am **going to introduce** my friend.
Ils **vont partir** en vacances.	They are **going to leave** on vacation.
Mes amis et moi **allons faire** la vaisselle.	My friends and I **are going to do** the dishes.
Elle **va faire** un vœu.	She is **going to make** a wish.
Le ciel est noir; il **va pleuvoir.**	The sky is dark; it is **going to rain.**
Je **ne vais pas inviter** Alice encore une fois, pas question !	I'm **not going to invite** Alice again, no way!

Note - **être sur le point de** is the semi-modal auxiliary, which has the value of Futur Proche. E.g **L'avion est sur le point de décoller** (The plane is about to take off).

Le Passé Récent (The Recent Past)

It is used to refer to completed actions that happened shortly in the recent past, before the moment of speaking. It is the equivalent of the English construction '**have just + past participle.**'

To conjugate it, we use the primary verb **Venir (in present tense)** followed by preposition **de** and the **Infinitive of the main action verb**. The verb **venir** is conjugated in present tense in accordance with the subject who has just performed the action in the recent past.

Moreover, you can add **juste** or **tout juste** to emphasize how recent the action is.

Venir (in present tense) + de + Infinitive (of the main action verb)

Français	English
Vous **venez de lire** ce document.	You **just read** this document.
Tu **viens de réserver** des billets.	You **just booked** the tickets.
Je **viens de retrouver** mes amis.	I **just met** my friends.
Le train **vient juste de partir.**	The train has **just left.**
Nous **venons de monter** dans l'avion.	We **just boarded** the plane.

Note - It cannot be used in the negative. For instance, the construction ~~**Je ne viens pas de dîner**~~ is incorrect. For negation, the passé composé would be used - **Je n'ai pas dîné.**